About the Poet



John Keats (1795 – 1821) was a British Romantic poet. Although trained to be a surgeon, Keats decided to devote himself wholly to poetry. Keats' secret, his power to sway and delight the readers, lies primarily in his gift for perceiving the world and living his moods and aspirations in terms of language. "A Thing of Beauty' is an excerpt from his poem 'Endymion: A Poetic Romance'. The poem is based on a Greek legend, in which Endymion, a beautiful young shepherd and poet who lived on Mount Latmos, had a vision of Cynthia, the Moon Goddess. The enchanted youth resolved to seek her out and so wandered away through the forest and down under the sea.

Glossary

bower (n)	-	shelter under the shade of trees
wreathing (v)	-	cover, surround, encircle something
pall (n)	-	covering
rills (n)	-	clear stream
sprinkling (v)	-	falling in fine drops

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A. Read the poem aloud twice.

B. Choose the correct answers

1. According to the poet, a thing of beauty is _____.

   a. a joy forever b. a pain forever

   c. a suffering forever d. neglected

2. Beautiful things never "pass in to nothingness " means that they _____.

   a. never increase b. create unpleasantness between friends

   c. never fade away d. always bring unhappiness

3. "Will keep a bower quiet for us" means _____.

   a. will give us peace and calm b. will stop unpleasant sound

   c. make our beds fit to sleep d. reduces noise

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